MA ENGLISH • SEMESTER 1

Block 2 — Unit 2: Teaching Strategies, Curriculum and Evaluation

ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING • M21EG01AC

Expanded exam notes | Simple teaching + developed argument

Based on the supplied SGOU self-learning material. Use the assigned primary texts for exact quotations and full scene or passage analysis.

The chapter in one sentence

Effective ELT connects purposeful materials, inclusive participation, coherent curriculum, and assessment evidence that improves teaching and learning.

Start with a picture

A lesson is a route, not a pile of resources. Its goals, examples, activities, and checks must point towards the same destination. A beautiful slide or frequent quiz does not help if it measures something else.

1. Literature as a language resource

Stories, poems, drama, and extracts can support vocabulary, interpretation, emotional involvement, and discussion of perspectives. They can also be difficult because of unfamiliar references, syntax, length, or sensitive subject matter.

Choose a text for a language and learning purpose, not only because it is famous. Prepare essential context, set a manageable reading task, then use the text in discussion, rewriting, performance, or comparison. Avoid reducing every poem to a grammar hunt or assuming one authorised personal response.

2. Learner factors

Prior knowledge, motivation, self-efficacy, language experience, opportunity, and classroom relationships influence participation. **Self-efficacy** is a learner’s belief about being able to perform a particular task; it is not a fixed measure of intelligence.

Preferences differ, but evidence does not justify assigning learners permanently to visual, auditory, or kinaesthetic types and matching every lesson to the label. Use varied, well-chosen representations and check learning directly.

3. Learning difficulties and inclusion

Dyslexia, dysgraphia, attention difficulties, and other needs can affect classroom access in different ways. A teacher should observe barriers, provide support, collaborate with appropriate specialists, and follow the institution’s procedures. One spelling error or poor score does not establish a diagnosis.

Readable layouts, explicit instructions, additional processing time, alternative response formats, structured models, and assistive resources can support participation. Accommodations should preserve the intended construct where assessment is involved. Do not assume a disability implies low overall ability.

4. Teaching aids, ICT, and e-resources

A useful resource serves an objective. Pictures can establish a situation; audio can provide listening evidence; a shared document can support revision; a recording can make interaction available for reflection.

Check accessibility, accuracy, copyright or permitted use, privacy, cost, connectivity, and distraction. Have a workable low-tech alternative. Technology does not automatically create interaction or learning, and personal student information should not be uploaded casually to an external service.

5. Authentic materials

An authentic material originates in a real communicative context, such as a timetable, announcement, menu, email, or public notice. Its original purpose differs from an exercise written only to display a structure.

Authenticity is not a guarantee of suitability. Adjust the task and support to learners, and explain any adaptation. A real local English notice may be more relevant than a polished recording chosen solely because its speaker is labelled native.

6. Curriculum, syllabus, and lesson

A **curriculum** includes broader aims, experiences, organisation, teaching, and evaluation. A **syllabus** commonly specifies the content or learning sequence of a course. A **lesson plan** arranges a particular teaching episode. Usage varies, but the scales should not be confused.

Curriculum development involves identifying needs, setting goals, choosing and organising content and experiences, implementing them, gathering evidence, and revising. **Implementation** is the work of putting the plan into practice, not merely publishing it.

Useful curriculum orientations include:

- **Subject-centred:** organised around disciplinary content.
- **Learner-centred:** starts from learners’ needs and participation.
- **Experience-centred:** foregrounds learning through meaningful experience.
- **Activity-centred:** organises work through purposeful action.
- **Integrated:** connects areas or skills around shared purposes.
- **Total curriculum:** includes the wider range of planned and experienced learning, not only a topic list.

These orientations can overlap. Dewey’s contribution helps explain experience and participation without proving that every activity teaches effectively.

7. Classroom techniques and soft skills

Lecture can provide efficient explanation; discovery tasks can develop inference; group work can support negotiation; questioning can reveal reasoning; a case study can connect concepts with situated decisions. Choose according to the objective rather than ranking one technique as always best.

Soft skills include communication, collaboration, responsibility, and related interpersonal practices. Define the observable behaviour you intend to teach instead of using the phrase as an unmeasurable compliment.

8. Assessment purposes

Diagnostic: identifies strengths and needs to plan support.

Placement: allocates learners to a suitable course or level.

Formative: evidence is used during learning to decide useful next steps.

Summative: makes an overall judgement for a reporting point or decision.

Achievement: examines learning connected with a taught programme.

Proficiency: concerns ability for a broader domain of use rather than one specific taught syllabus.

High-stakes: describes the consequences of a decision, not a separate question format. A summative judgement can use varied tasks.

9. Assessment, testing, and evaluation

A **test** is a structured way of eliciting a sample of performance. **Assessment** includes broader evidence-gathering and judgement. **Evaluation** can also concern the value or effectiveness of a course, resource, or programme. The terms overlap in some traditions; explain the sense you use.

Criterion-referenced interpretation compares performance with defined criteria. **Norm-referenced** interpretation compares it with a relevant group. Neither is automatically fair without appropriate design and evidence.

10. Qualities of a good assessment

- **Validity:** evidence supports the intended interpretation and use. If you claim to assess discussion, obtain evidence of discussion, not only spelling.
- **Reliability:** scores or judgements are sufficiently consistent across relevant occasions, tasks, and raters. Rubrics, training, and moderation can help.
- **Authenticity:** the task meaningfully relates to the target use, where appropriate.
- **Objectivity:** minimise irrelevant personal judgement through clear criteria; an essay can still be assessed systematically.
- **Practicality:** time, resources, administration, and marking are feasible.

- **Fairness and access:** avoid irrelevant barriers and unjustified assumptions.
- **Washback:** examine effects on teaching and learning. A narrow test may encourage narrow practice even when its marking is consistent.

Reliability alone does not establish validity: a consistently scored irrelevant task is still inadequate for the claimed purpose.

11. Continuous and external assessment

Continuous assessment gathers evidence over time. It should not mean unending graded pressure. Portfolios, observations, projects, discussions, quizzes, and revised writing can show different dimensions of learning.

External assessment can support comparability or an independent judgement, but its value depends on alignment, quality, context, and consequences. Internal does not mean automatically biased; external does not mean automatically valid.

12. Designing a question paper

Begin with outcomes and a blueprint: which skills, topics, cognitive demands, task types, time, and marks are needed? Provide clear instructions and a defensible marking scheme or rubric. Pilot where possible, check language demand and access, then review the results.

Use appropriate items rather than only easy-to-mark ones. A multiple-choice item may test recognition; a performance task may better assess interaction. Bloom’s taxonomy can broaden cognitive demand but cannot replace a language-use objective.

13. Formative versus summative in practice

A short paragraph becomes formative when feedback helps the learner revise and helps the teacher choose the next instruction. Merely returning a score does not establish that function.

At a reporting point, a summative task may use the same skill with criteria already understood. Feedback can still support later learning. Purpose and use distinguish the functions more reliably than frequency alone.

14. Constructive alignment and revision

Constructive alignment connects outcomes, learning activity, and assessment. If the goal is a persuasive request, learners need relevant models, practice, and a task scored for meaningful success and language—not an unrelated word list.

After assessment, identify patterns, examine task quality, provide feedback, and revise instruction or curriculum where evidence warrants it. Assessment completes a feedback loop rather than ending learning.

Quick check

1. Does reliability automatically prove validity? **No.**
2. Is every frequent quiz formative? **No; its use matters.**

3. Must authentic materials be unadapted and from native speakers? **No.**
4. Should a teacher diagnose a disability from one mistake? **No.**

Build an exam answer

1. State the learner context and observable outcomes.
2. Align materials and activities with those outcomes.
3. Use diagnostic and formative evidence with revision opportunities.
4. Design a summative task and rubric; justify validity, reliability, and access.
5. Explain feasibility, consequences, and how results revise the unit.

Common mistake to avoid

Do not confuse frequency with formative purpose, fixed learning-style matching with inclusion, or an externally produced test with automatic validity.

Developed exam discussion

Practice question

Design an inclusive, constructively aligned assessment plan for an ELT unit.

Explain the argument in fuller paragraphs

An assessment plan begins with the ability the unit intends to develop. If learners must make and respond to a request, the outcomes should describe an observable performance in a relevant context. Materials, classroom activity, and assessment then need to elicit that performance. A grammar-only test cannot sustain a broad claim about interaction, even if its answers are scored consistently.

Diagnostic evidence can identify starting needs. During teaching, models, supported practice, peer exchange, and a formative performance allow the teacher to observe problems. Feedback should name an actionable improvement and provide another opportunity to use it. A checklist becomes useful when learners and teachers act on the evidence, not simply because it is administered repeatedly.

The final judgement needs a clear task and rubric. Criteria may distinguish communicative completion, appropriateness, coherence, interactional repair, and relevant language control. Rater discussion and exemplars can improve consistency. Fairness requires checking whether reading load, technology, cultural assumptions, or response conditions introduce barriers unrelated to the ability being assessed.

The plan should also be feasible. External comparison can be useful, but no external instrument should be selected without examining its target population and intended use. Continuous classroom evidence can supplement one performance where a consequential decision is required.

Finally, results must inform curriculum revision. A shared weakness may indicate insufficient opportunity to practise, an unclear model, a poor task, or a language need. Investigating

these alternatives turns assessment from a sorting mechanism into a source of improved teaching. That is the practical force of constructive alignment.

Use the discussion well

Answer the exact question, not every possible topic. Make one clear point per paragraph, support it with a textual detail or a relevant classroom example, and explain its significance. Check exact quotations against the assigned text. The discussion is paraphrase and guidance, not a quotation or a guaranteed exam answer.

Textbook assignment checklist

The following numbered prompts are retained from the unit for revision. Obvious source errors are discussed in the coverage review; a prompt's assumptions should not be accepted automatically. These are not predictions or complete written assignments.

1. What are the advantages and challenges of using literature in English language teaching? Provide examples and discuss how literature-based learning can benefit language education.
2. What strategies can teachers use to incorporate literature into English language teaching? Provide examples and discuss how different types of literature, such as short stories, novels, and poetry, can be used to develop language skills.
3. How can teachers support learners with learning disabilities in the classroom? Provide examples of accommodations and modifications that can be used.
4. What are the benefits and limitations of using digital language learning platforms for language acquisition? How can learners supplement their digital learning experience?
5. Design a lesson plan for teaching vocabulary using teaching aids in an elementary school English class. In your lesson plan, include the following details: Grade level: 4th grade Vocabulary theme: Food Learning objective: Students will be able to identify and use food-related vocabulary words in sentences. Teaching aids: Pictures of different foods, flashcards, a worksheet with fillin-the-blank sentences, a memory-matching game Teaching strategy: Communicative Language Teaching (CLT)
6. What are the different assessment purposes in English Language Teaching (ELT)? Provide a brief explanation for each.
7. What is the difference between continuous and traditional summative assessments in ELT?
8. What are the key components of a well-designed question paper for ELT, and why is it important to use authentic materials? Give examples of effective question types for ELT question papers.
9. Write an essay based on the differences between summative and formative tests in education.